DIH 08 - Seven Main Buses Core Mix Routing

Status: website-ready Logic starter, preset-recall revision 2026-10-19.

This is the public configuration note for the downloadable Logic Pro package `DIH 08 - Seven Main Buses - Core Mix Routing.logicx`. WIDTH, FIELD TONE ALT, CREATIVE TRANSFORM, and individual spatial returns are optional support lanes, not additional mandatory main buses. The current family authority and routing placement canon control family membership and lane purpose; the plugin source code controls wet/dry and gain behavior.

Main signal path

```
Source tracks -> one of DRUM / BASS / INSTRUMENT / VOCAL
             -> optional sends to EFFECTS / COLOR / DYNAMICS / WIDTH
All active buses and returns -> Bus 9 MASTER BUS -> Stereo Out
```

- DRUM: Drum Morpher belongs on an instrument track; start the Drum bus with `TIGHT BUS GLUE [Stereo]` in DRUMKRUSHGLUE. `DRUM OVERHEAD PHI [Stereo]` in WPR belongs on an overhead/room return. SlotMachine on this bus is a bypassed creative alternate, not default drum glue.
- BASS: `KHEPRI BASS FOUNDATION` -> `MONOLITH BODY WEIGHT`. NTRPL and DEPTH BOOST PRO are bypassed alternatives, not additional default active stages.
- INSTRUMENT and COLOR: `Chain: Music Bus Foundation` in KHEPRI -> APIS. PTAHTUBE or SOVEREIGN replaces APIS when approved; do not make all three active by default.
- VOCAL: choose the lead-vocal reference or the purpose-matched alternate after level matching. Do not activate every vocal insert by default.
- DYNAMICS: use only the processors needed for the pass, at most three active.
- WIDTH: dimensional movement is distinct from shared reverb/delay. Mono-check before print.
- MASTER BUS: PLATINUM -> IMHOTEP -> ANKH, with SESHAT on the final observation endpoint. IMHOTEP is the sole MASTER_FIELD family member. Do not send the MASTER BUS to a parallel path that reaches Stereo Out around ANKH.

Collector buses

Bus 12, Bus 13, and Bus 14 are structural collector returns, not extra creative effects sends.

- Bus 12 / Aux 12: collects DRUM and BASS, then feeds Bus 9.
- Bus 13 / Aux 13: collects COLOR, then feeds Bus 9.
- Bus 14 / Aux 14: collects EFFECTS, WIDTH, and the independent spatial returns, then feeds Bus 9.

Keep these collectors clean and boring. They exist to preserve the seven-bus architecture and make the final route easy to audit.

Shared spatial effects

For the most controllable starter, use three individual 100%-wet send returns: NTRSTLLR Delay, Cathedral Room, and SacredVerb Chamber. Route their outputs to Bus 14 / Aux 14, then Bus 9. Start source sends at minus infinity; raise only the send needed. This is a control and gain-staging improvement, not an inherent fidelity upgrade. The existing Bus 5 EFFECTS lane can remain available as the serial Parallel Spatial Bus option, but it should not be the default path for three independent shared spaces.

Code basis: NTRSTLLR and Cathedral default to Mix 1.0; SacredVerb implements a wet/dry blend and therefore needs Wet Mix 1.0 for a conventional aux return. Compare level and tail behavior after changing any preset.

Current saved Logic state, 2026-09-26: Bus 16 is named NTRSTLLR DELAY, contains NTRSTLLR, and outputs Bus 14. Bus 17 is named CATHEDRAL ROOM, contains Cathedral with Mix 1.00, and outputs Bus 14. Bus 18 is labeled SACREDVERB, contains SacredVerb, is active, and outputs Bus 14.

Creative Transform

Primary placement is a deliberate source insert. The optional Bus 15 CREATIVE TRANSFORM return is for a parallel creative blend only; it routes to Bus 9 and starts with source sends at minus infinity. Keep Archaeologist X -> SERQET -> SlotMachine available, but normally activate just the chosen creative processor. SlotMachine stays last whenever it is in a chain.

Archaeologist X defaults to an internal Mix of about 0.618 and SlotMachine always retains a dry component even at maximum Blend. On a send return, that dry contribution sums with the main path and may change level or tone. For Archaeologist X parallel use, audition Mix 1.0, level-match, and check the result in mono. SlotMachine is better treated as an insert or a consciously blended effect than as a conventional wet-only return. SERQET is a creative width/movement choice, not transparent correction; mono-check it.

Field Tone Balance

AUSAR restoration and AUSET field tilt belong to FIELD_TONE_BALANCE, not MASTER_FIELD. FIELD TONE ALT is an optional source/stem-fed Bus 11 return into Bus 9. Do not feed it from Bus 9: that would create a loop. HORIZON X is a bypassed mastering alternate, not part of the field-tone pair. If field-tone processing is not called for, leave Bus 11 without active sends.

Website release gate

1. Keep customer media out of the downloadable Logic starter.
2. Verify COLOR uses `Chain: Music Bus Foundation` in KHEPRI -> APIS; PTAHTUBE or SOVEREIGN is an approved replacement, not an added third color stage.
3. Verify every aux destination reaches Bus 9 exactly once through the intended collector: Bus 12 for DRUM/BASS, Bus 13 for COLOR, and Bus 14 for EFFECTS/WIDTH/spatial returns.
4. Verify every default send is off, the master chain is serial, and no lane has more than three active musical processors.
5. Reopen the saved project in Logic, confirm no missing-media or missing-plugin alert, and perform a level-matched audible/mono check on each optional return.

Sources: `CURRENT_FAMILY_AUTHORITY.md`, `ROUTING_PLACEMENT_CANON.md`, `MANUALS_CURRENT/CREATIVE_TRANSFORM/USER_MANUAL.md`, and current processor code in `DIH_FINISHED` for NTRSTLLR, Cathedral, SacredVerb, Archaeologist X, SERQET, and SlotMachine.